EXPERIMENT 12: SECURITY AND GOVERNANCE IN ZOHO CREATOR

AIM

To configure, enforce, and audit enterprise-grade security policies, conditional access controls, and compliance governance mechanisms within Zoho Creator for the 'Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management' system. The objective is to establish organization-wide password and authentication baselines, evaluate risk-based conditional access policies, inspect user-to-application role mappings, and audit immutable administrative event logs.

APPLICATION CONTEXT & SYSTEM OVERVIEW

Enterprise software handling sensitive vehicle maintenance data, billing estimates, and customer records requires comprehensive security governance. Zoho Creator implements zero-trust governance through integrated identity management via Zoho Directory. This framework comprises: (1) Organizational Security Policies enforcing password complexity and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), (2) Conditional Access Policies validating network context, IP restrictions, and device health before granting access, and (3) Centralized Audit Trails recording all administrative operations, permission changes, and authentication events with actor identities and chronological timestamps.

PROCEDURE

Step 1: Accessing Organizational Governance Console

Navigate to the administrative control panel of Zoho Creator under the registered developer tenant. From the left navigation menu under 'MANAGE', select 'Governance'. The console displays centralized governing principles including Security Policies, Custom Authentication, Active Directory federation, and Domain validation.

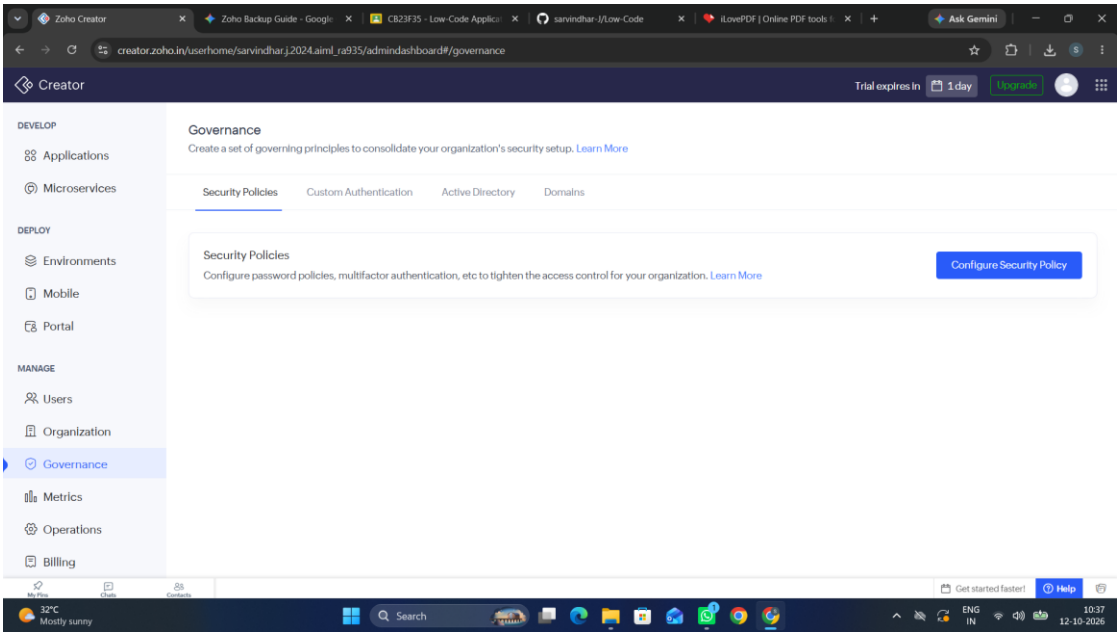


Figure 12.1: Organizational Governance Console and Security Policy Overview

Step 2: Configuring Conditional Access Policies

Launch the enterprise directory security suite by selecting 'Configure Security Policy'. Navigate to 'Conditional Access Policies' to evaluate rule-based access gating. Conditional access enforces 'if-then' criteria based on client IP addresses, recognized devices, geographical coordinates, and mandatory Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) challenges.

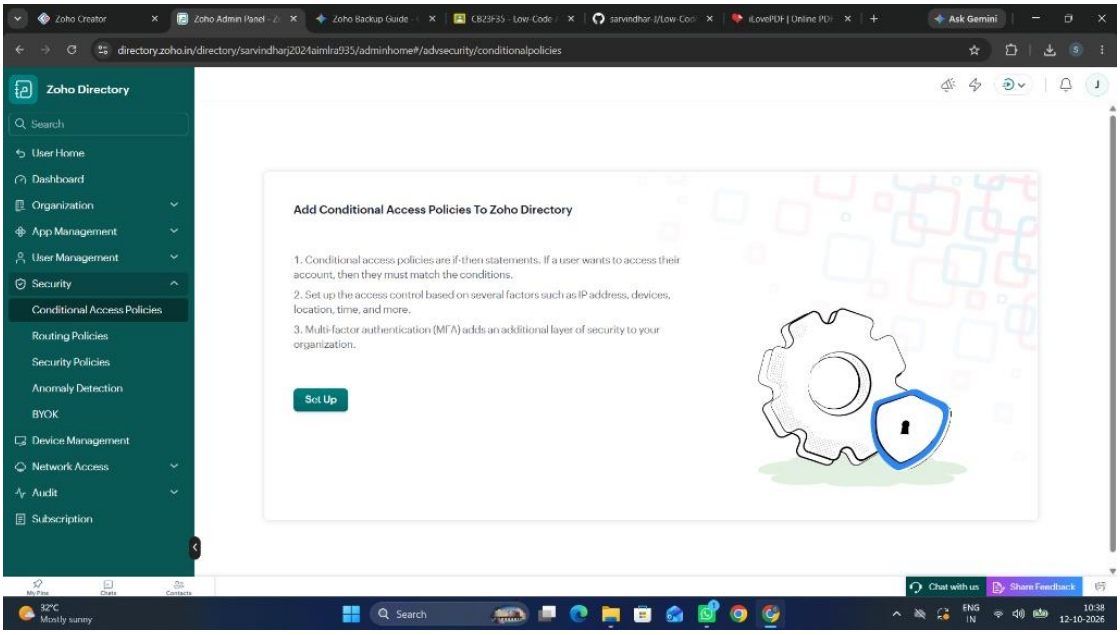


Figure 12.2: Conditional Access Policy Management and Contextual Security Evaluation

Step 3: Auditing Organization-Wide Security Policies

Inspect the 'Security Policies' repository within Zoho Directory. The policy configuration table displays the Default Policy assigned to 'Everyone'. This interface allows administrators to mandate credential complexity rules, enforce session timeout limits, and restrict administrative sign-ins.

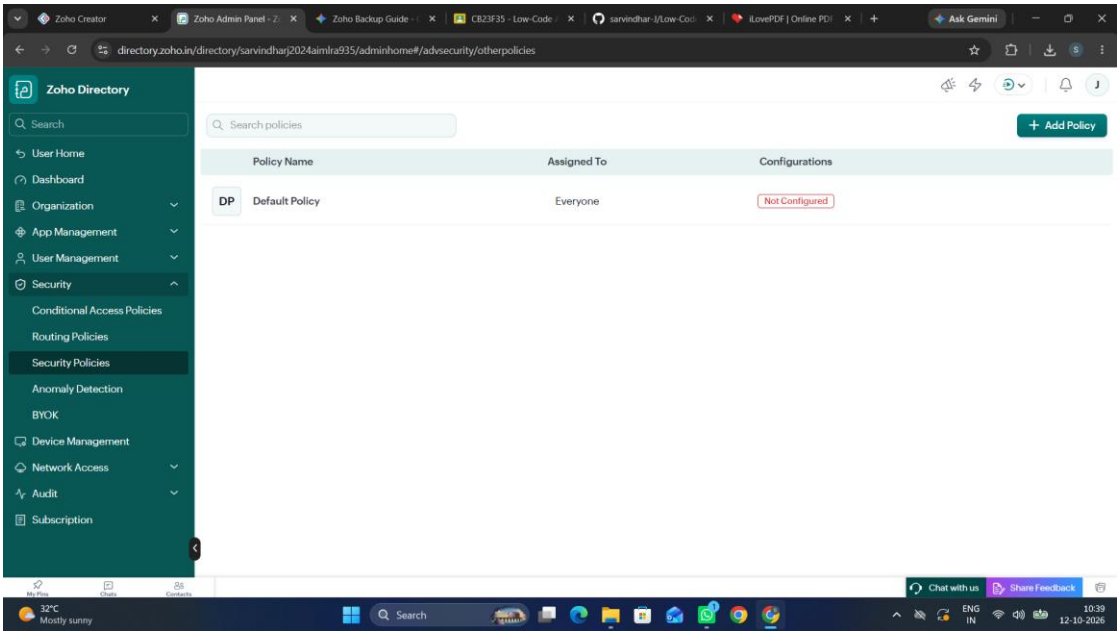


Figure 12.3: Security Policies Repository and Default Tenant Baseline Policy

Step 4: Reviewing Security and Governance Intelligence Reports

Navigate to the 'Audit' drawer and select 'Reports'. The centralized governance dashboard monitors five critical operational domains: User lifecycles, Login security (successful and failed sign-ins), Application telemetry (user-app role mapping), Device trust states, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) adoption rates.

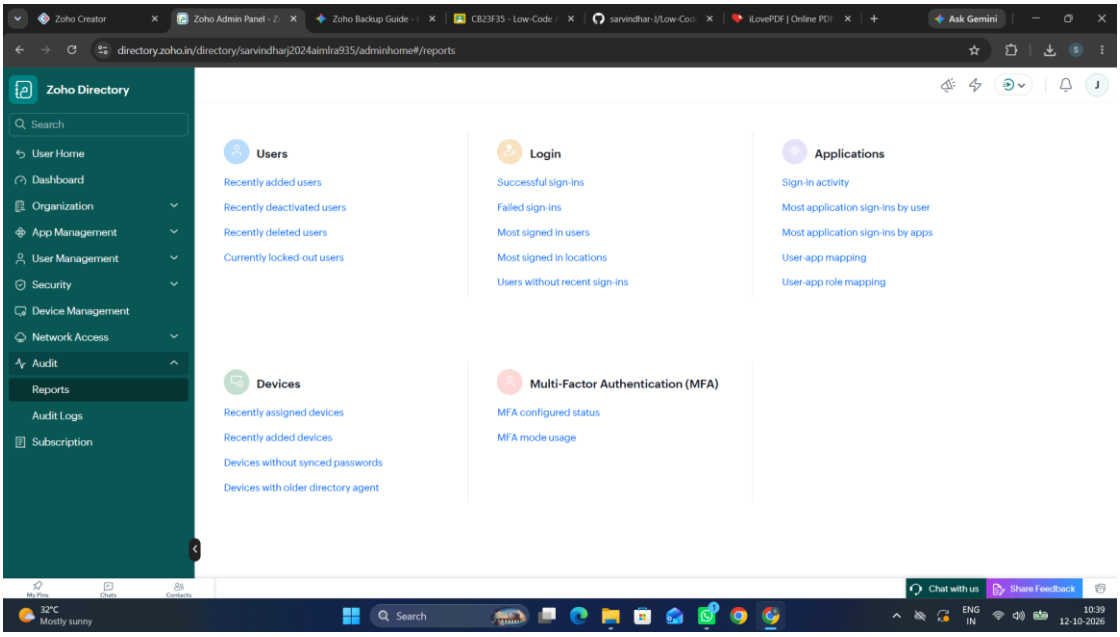


Figure 12.4: Centralized Governance and Security Intelligence Reports Dashboard

Step 5: Verifying Real-Time Audit Logs and Actor Activity

Select 'Audit Logs' under the Audit section to review immutable administrative event trails. Filter by activity and date range to inspect logged operations—including 'Created user invitation details', 'Added/Updated location', and 'Reset password'—each recorded with precise date-time stamps, actor email identity (sarvindhar.j.2024.aiml@rajalakshmi.edu.in), target resources, and affected system modules.

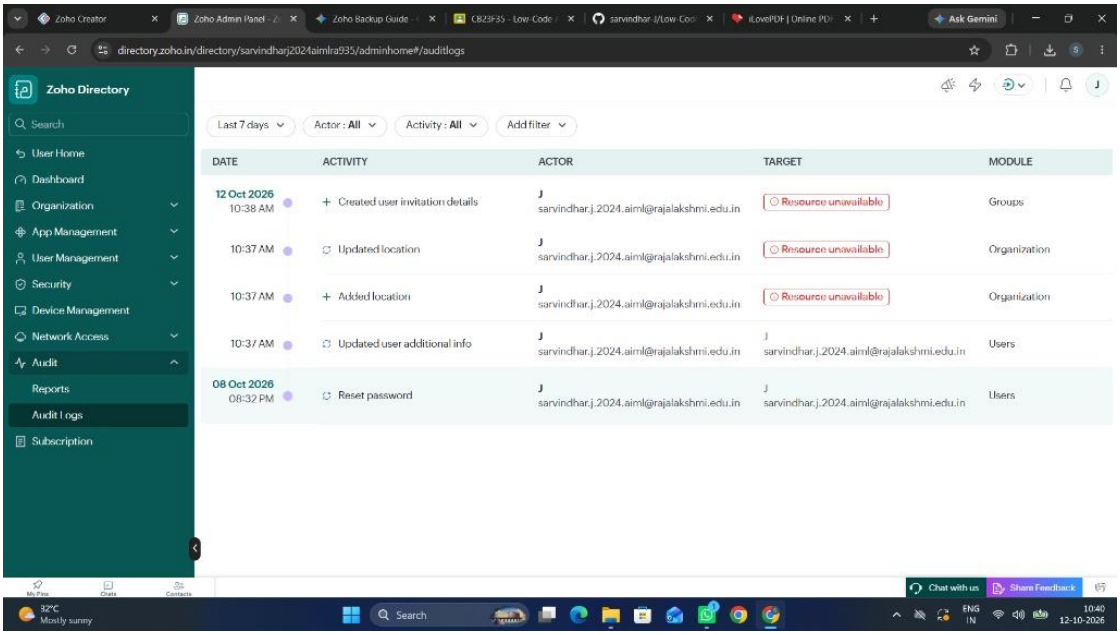


Figure 12.5: Chronological Audit Trail and Administrative Event Logs

RESULT

Thus, enterprise security policies, conditional access controls, and administrative governance mechanisms in Zoho Creator were successfully analyzed, configured, and verified. Comprehensive access security was established across authentication layers, and immutable audit logging was validated for the 'Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management' enterprise application.